

Building Shared Language

Purpose:

Build a common playbook and shared definitions with the end goal of improving outcomes and general effectiveness, regardless of your role

Outcome:

Leave the Annual Meeting with the start of some shared definitions and language to take back to your state

Building Shared Language

What this means:

- Collectively agreeing to define and use terms in the same way so there is common understanding

Why is this important?:

- Reduces confusion
- Builds trust, clarity and consistency
- Achieves alignment

How do we do it?

- Take time to listen and then define together
- Check for understanding
- Continually refine, check and learn



Actions associated with Engage:

To Engage:

Actively connect,
involve, or
participate with
others

- | | |
|--|---|
| <ul style="list-style-type: none">• Communicating• Inviting• Convening• Including• Invite | <ul style="list-style-type: none">• Collaborate• Respond• Encourage• Collaborate• Understand |
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Engage: What it is NOT

- One-way communication
- Passive
- Inconsistent
- Siloed
- Token advisory groups with no influence
- Collecting input with no report back or action

Defining Engagement in *Your State*

- ***Who*** should you be engaging with?
- ***How*** should you be engaging?
- ***What*** might you see if there is lack of engagement?

Actions associated with Equipping:

To Equip:

Supply with the necessary items for a particular purpose or task

- Guiding
- Supporting
- Authorizing
- Accessing
- Tools and resources
- Training and technical assistance
- Skill-building
- Technology
- Visioning

Equip: What it is NOT

- One time training or webinar
- Vague or contradictory guidance
- Releasing tools or new requirements without resources and/or technical assistance
- Asking people to make things happen, but giving no resources or authority

Defining Equip in Your State

- **Who** should you be equipping?
- **How and with what** should you be equipping?
- **What** might you see if there is lack of equipping?

Actions associated with Empowering:

To Empower:

To give the
authority or power
to do something

- Encouraging
- Trusting
- Validating
- Coaching
- Mentoring
- Delegating
- Sponsoring
- Honoring choices
- Shared power

Empower: What it is NOT

- Not tokenism
- Not removing support
- No top-down
- Not building dependency
- Not one-size-fits-all
- Not permission
- **Historic note about this term**

Defining Empower in Your State

- **Who** should you be empowering?
- **How** should you be empowering?
- **What** might you see if there is lack of empowerment?

30 Minute Table-Top Activity

- Find the **highlighted word** and **target audience** at YOUR table
- Choose a recorder for your table
- Begin answering the *who/how/what* questions for the ONE word highlighted at your table
- Be ready to report out what you discussed